Ainul Yaqiin M. Mabaning

Ainul Yaqiin M. Mabaning is a Maranao human resources executive, strategic communications specialist, and business leader known for building organizational excellence across corporate, non-profit, and entrepreneurial sectors. Currently serving as Chief Executive Officer of Batal Human Resource Services since October 2024, she brings more than two decades of integrated HR, leadership development, and communications expertise to her roles. Her career trajectory reflects a distinctive commitment to strategic vision, integrity, and professional excellence grounded in her Maranao cultural identity. Mabaning is perhaps best recognized for her award-winning contributions to professional communications and leadership, earning international recognition through Toastmasters International achievements while building substantive impact in organizational transformation and talent development.

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Early Life and Background

Ainul Yaqiin M. Mabaning was born and raised in Iligan City, a major industrial and commercial hub on the island of Mindanao. As a native Maranao speaker fluent in professional English, conversational Bisaya, and conversational Arabic, she grew up navigating multiple cultural and linguistic contexts that would later define her approach to organizational leadership and cross-cultural communication. Her upbringing in Iligan exposed her to the entrepreneurial spirit of the region and the professional culture of its business community. Her native fluency in Maranao reflects deep roots in the broader Bangsamoro cultural heritage, while her multilingual competence and international exposure shaped her perspective on leadership as a bridge between local identity and global professional standards.

The formative experiences of her childhood in Iligan would resurface later in her entrepreneurial ventures, including her ownership and management of Big Poppa's Diner, which she established in 2020 and operated successfully while maintaining her executive roles. This balance between professional management and community-rooted enterprise reflects a characteristic philosophy: that organizational excellence need not be disconnected from cultural grounding or local roots.

Education

Mabaning completed her undergraduate education at Columbus University in Mississippi, United States, where she earned a Bachelor of Science in Business Administration with a major in Marketing in 2006. Her undergraduate focus on marketing provided foundational knowledge in consumer behavior, brand strategy, and organizational communications that would inform her later work in HR consulting and leadership development.

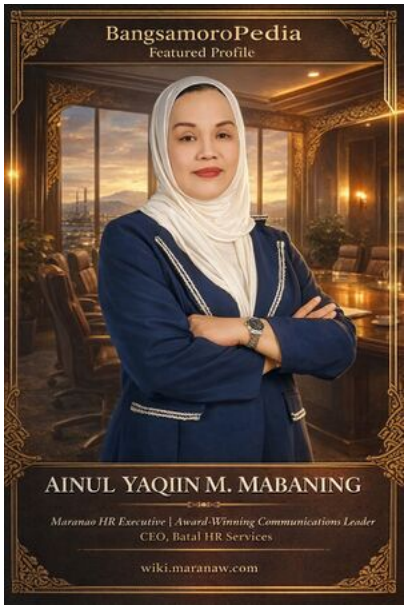
She advanced her education through the prestigious Asian Institute of Management (AIM), where she earned her Master of Business Administration degree between 2010 and 2011. The AIM program is recognized as one of Asia's leading business schools and emphasizes strategic leadership, organizational behavior, and integrated business management. Her MBA equipped her with advanced frameworks for strategic planning, organizational transformation, and executive leadership that proved instrumental in her subsequent career progression.

Career

Early Teaching and International Experience

Mabaning began her professional career in education, serving as a College Instructor and Administrative Coordinator at the International Philippine School in Riyadh, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, from 2007 to 2012. She taught Marketing, Business Law, Economics, and Financial Management while managing HR-related functions including timekeeping, recruitment, onboarding, and employee experience initiatives. This role marked her entry into the integrated practice of HR and organizational development, setting a pattern she would expand throughout her career: combining institutional knowledge with hands-on people management.

Her time in Riyadh expanded her cultural competency and international professional networks, exposing her to the diverse challenges of managing multinational education organizations and



Ainul Yaqiin M. Mabaning	
Position	**CEO, Batal Human Resource Services**
Born	**Iligan City, Philippines**
Education	**Asian Institute of Management MBA (2011); Columbus University BSBA Marketing (2006)**
Native language	**Maranao, Filipino**
Other languages	**Professional English, Conversational Bisaya, Conversational Arabic**
Religion	**Islam**
Known for	**Award-winning HR leadership; international Toastmasters distinction; bridging strategic organizational excellence with Maranao cultural identity**
Occupation	**Chief Executive Officer, Human Resources Director, Communications Officer, Business Owner**
Organization	**Batal Human Resource Services**
Awards	**Table Topics City Champion (1998); Centennial Best Debate Speaker of the Philippines (1998); International Speech Contest Champion, Middle East (2000); International Evaluation Master Champion, Middle East (2001)**

preparing her for later roles in international consulting and cross-cultural communications.

HR and Communications Leadership at Schedio Consulting

From 2012 to 2018, Mabaning served as Senior Manager of HR, Administration, and Communications at Schedio Consulting Inc. in Makati City. This role consolidated her expertise across three integrated domains. In the HR function, she managed end-to-end staffing from recruiting through onboarding, designed compensation strategies based on market research, developed performance management frameworks, and conducted strategic HR planning with emphasis on retention. Her administrative responsibilities included operational improvements and financial reporting. On the communications side, she led development of the company's Communications Plan and created strategies supporting organizational goals and brand reach.

This position reflected her growing sophistication in organizational design and her ability to manage competing priorities across domains typically siloed in other organizations. Her approach integrated HR strategy with internal and external communications, recognizing that talent management and organizational messaging operate as interconnected systems.

Red Cross and Development Work

Between 2018 and 2019, Mabaning served as Communications Officer for the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) in Iligan City. The role built on her communications expertise while introducing her to the non-profit humanitarian sector. She developed and executed communication strategies for organizational programs and beneficiaries, handled external relations, created content, and coordinated community engagement initiatives. This experience deepened her understanding of communications as a tool for social impact and organizational accountability.

In 2018, she earned recognition as Chief Training Expert in Communications During Crisis through the ICRC, a credential that speaks to her depth in managing organizational messaging under challenging circumstances.

Senior Delivery Management at the Asian Development Bank

From 2021 to 2023, Mabaning served as Senior Delivery Manager at Talentium Inc., managing the Asian Development Bank (ADB) Special IT Team responsible for eLearning and video output production. She managed HR functions including onboarding, payroll, timesheet management, benefits, and employee relations while leading AGILE project management and ensuring timely delivery of major outputs. This role required her to blend technical project management with personnel management, coordinating stakeholder communications across development finance institutions and technology teams.

During this period, she was appointed as Project Management Resource Speaker for the ADB and Talentium, delivering expertise in organizational project delivery across the Asia-Pacific region.

Human Resources Director at Arlene de Castro Law Firm

From November 2023 to February 2024, Mabaning served as Human Resources Director at Arlene de Castro Law Firm in Bonifacio Global City, Taguig. In this brief but intensive role, she collaborated with the Managing Partner and Core Group on HR goals, staffing strategies, and workforce planning. She planned and implemented HR policies, processes, training, and organizational development initiatives. Internally, she administered comprehensive HR programs including compensation, benefits, leave management, disciplinary matters, and

performance management. Externally, she designed and implemented HR consulting products, supervised external projects, and attended exploratory sessions with prospective clients. She also served as Webinar Resource Speaker for the firm's HR-focused programs during this period.

Chief Executive Officer of Batal Human Resource Services

In October 2024, Mabaning assumed the position of Chief Executive Officer of Batal Human Resource Services, her current role. As CEO, she provides overall strategic leadership and direction across all service lines, including HR Consulting, Talent Solutions, Leadership Development Programs, and Client Advisory Services. She leads business development initiatives, client acquisition, and partnership expansion while directing the creation and refinement of HR frameworks, training modules, and leadership methodologies. She supervises operations, finance, HR, marketing, and service delivery teams, represents the company in speaking engagements and corporate training events, and maintains direct oversight of key client accounts and large-scale HR projects. This role represents the culmination of her career trajectory: from integrated functional expertise to executive strategic leadership.

Entrepreneurship: Big Poppa's Diner

Since 2020, Mabaning has served as Owner and General Manager of Big Poppa's Diner in Iligan City, managing full operational aspects including HR, finance, administration, and marketing. She oversees staffing, vendor relations, quality control, and customer experience while building the restaurant's brand and market position. In 2022, the diner earned recognition as 1st Runner Up in the Best Halal Restaurant Category at the Iligan Business Awards, a testament to her ability to integrate professional hospitality management with culturally grounded product and service excellence.

Professional Recognition and Speaking Engagements

Mabaning's professional achievements extend significantly into communications and public leadership through her work with Toastmasters International, where she achieved multiple championships and leadership roles. These recognitions underscore her expertise in persuasive communication, organizational speaking, and leadership presence.

Between 1998 and 2001, she earned four major international titles: Table Topics City Champion with Riyadh Toastmasters (1998), Centennial Best Debate Speaker of the Philippines awarded by the Philippine Embassy (1998), International Speech Contest Champion for the Middle East region (2000), and International Evaluation Master Champion for the Middle East region (2001). In 2001, she served as Chief Judge for the International Conference of Toastmasters in Bahrain, reflecting her standing within the organization.

Beyond Toastmasters, she has been engaged as Chief Trainer for Islamic Banking Opportunities for SMEs through Amanah Bank (2017), Chief Training Expert for Communications During Crisis through the International Committee of the Red Cross (2018), and as Webinar Resource Speaker and Session Chair for the South East Asian Symposium and Expo in Quezon City (2025). These appointments reflect her recognition as a subject matter expert in organizational communications, HR strategy, and professional development.

Contributions to Organizational Excellence

Mabaning's career reflects a consistent commitment to building systems of organizational excellence across diverse sectors. Her contributions span several domains:

HR Strategy and Talent Development. She has designed comprehensive HR frameworks, compensation structures, and performance management systems for organizations ranging from law firms to multinational education providers to development finance institutions. Her work emphasizes the integration of market-based compensation strategy with talent retention and organizational culture.

Communications and Organizational Messaging. She has led the development of organizational communications plans, content strategies, and external messaging for enterprises and non-profits. Her approach treats communications as integral to organizational strategy rather than peripheral to it, linking internal alignment with external brand positioning.

Leadership Development and Professional Communications. Her Toastmasters achievements and subsequent training roles demonstrate deep expertise in developing leaders' communication capabilities, persuasive speaking, and presence. Her training in communications during crisis situations reflects her ability to support organizations through high-stakes messaging scenarios.

Organizational Transformation. Across multiple roles, she has managed the change management, staffing, and operational dimensions of organizational transitions, from establishing new service lines to expanding market reach.

Legacy and Cultural Significance

Mabaning's career arc embodies a distinctive bridge between international professional excellence and Maranao cultural identity. As a native Maranao speaker who earned Toastmasters championships, pursued an MBA from Asia's leading business schools, and built executive leadership across the region, she represents the expanding presence of Maranao women in strategic organizational roles and professional leadership. Her fluency in Maranao, alongside professional English and conversational Arabic, reflects a multilingual competence often underrepresented in executive ranks.

Her success as an entrepreneur through Big Poppa's Diner, achieving recognition in the Iligan Business Awards while maintaining her executive roles, demonstrates her capacity to build culturally rooted enterprises alongside institutional leadership. This integration of professional excellence with cultural grounding offers a model distinct from narratives that treat cultural identity and corporate advancement as competing rather than complementary dimensions of leadership.

Her legacy centers on strategic organizational building grounded in integrity and dedicated to developing others. Throughout her career, she has invested in talent development, organizational systems, and leadership communications as mechanisms for sustainable enterprise. Her current role as CEO of Batal HR Services positions her to scale these contributions across the Philippine business landscape.

Personal Values and Interests

Mabaning's professional philosophy, as articulated in her professional summary, emphasizes dedication, strategic vision, and strong integrity. In her personal life, she maintains active interests in volleyball, badminton, music, and oration. Her advanced standing as a Toastmaster Silver and her recognition as a Communications Expert reflect sustained commitment to the discipline of public speaking and leadership communication. Her coaching and mentoring skills, documented across multiple roles, indicate a personal investment in developing others.

See Also

- Asian Institute of Management
- Toastmasters International
- Maranao people
- Iligan City
- Bangsamoro people
- International Committee of the Red Cross
- Asian Development Bank

Further Reading

- Ainul Yaqiin M. Mabaning CV (2026). Professional experience and educational credentials.
- Batal Human Resource Services corporate materials.
- Toastmasters International achievement records, Middle East region (1998–2001).

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